Jamilet Yalan Mendez

jami-yalan.github.io/PD-Portfolio/ | jam.yaln@gmail.com | linkedin/jamyln | Edinburgh, UK - willing to relocate | No visa sponsorship required

PROFILE

UX and product designer with 8 years of experience across financial services, healthcare and education in Latin America and the UK. Combines strong research foundations with hands-on execution across the full design cycle, from discovery and journey mapping to wireframing, prototyping and iterative testing. Experienced working within agile product teams at pace, collaborating with engineers, product managers and business stakeholders to ship user-centred digital experiences. Brings fluency in Figma and Miro, an active interest in AI-augmented design workflows, and a growing ability to bridge design and development through AI-assisted coding, enabling end-to-end delivery from concept to shipped product.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Service Designer | Royal London

May 2025 - March 2026

- Led end-to-end discovery for two programmes, conducting 23 qualitative research sessions with financially and emotionally vulnerable customers to define user needs, identify systemic gaps and shape the design strategy for both initiatives.
- Synthesised research into 16 actionable insights, reframing the problem statement for both programmes and directly influencing the design strategy and product direction.
- Designed and tested sacrificial concepts across five iterative rounds with 24 participants, using Figma to prototype communications and initial app screen concepts as conversation artefacts to surface user needs and validate design direction.
- Produced end-to-end journey maps and design specifications across advised and direct-to-consumer channels, working closely with UX designers, legal and marketing to incorporate accessibility and compliance requirements.
- Facilitated co-design sessions and cross-functional workshops with underwriting, claims, customer service and product teams to align on design decisions and build shared ownership of improvements.

Methods: qualitative research, iterative prototyping, usability testing, interaction design, cross-functional facilitation.

Senior UX Designer | Globant Peru

Oct 2021 - Nov 2023

- Designed student onboarding service for Laureate Universities, reducing dropout rates through journey mapping and co-designed interventions with academic and administrative stakeholders.
- Facilitated 20+ cross-cultural co-design workshops spanning four countries to align diverse stakeholder groups on service vision and implementation priorities.
- Led end-to-end design for multinational clients including Autodesk USA, Hospital Albert Einstein (Brazil) and BCI Bank Chile, managing competing stakeholder priorities across technical and business teams.
- Mentored junior designers in service design methodologies and established shared documentation standards across four product teams.

Workshop Facilitator | Repensar

May 2021 - Nov 2023

- Designed and delivered a 3-month Service Design curriculum training 100+ designers across Latin America in service design methodologies, systems thinking and co-creation techniques.
- Achieved 95% student satisfaction through hands-on workshop formats and real-world case studies.

Senior UX Designer | Crehana

Mar 2021 - Oct 2021

- Established the UX practice from scratch as the first UX designer in the B2C division, defining team ways of working, ceremonies and deliverable frameworks to make design visible and actionable across product squads.
- Challenged the business assumptions about course discoverability through qualitative research, demonstrating that the root cause was a content gap rather than a search or taxonomy problem, successfully reframing the project scope and securing stakeholder buy-in for an MVP.
- Recruited and mentored a content designer transitioning into UX, supporting their professional development and expanding the team's research and design capacity.
- Increased student engagement through a strategic homepage redesign informed by user research and iterative testing.

Product and Service Designer | Farmacias Peruanas Jan 2020 - Feb 2021

- Designed and shipped a multi-product operations platform suite under pandemic conditions, giving a team of 20 real-time control over delivery capacity, store closures and order management across Lima's pharmacy network.
- Designed an Android app for delivery drivers covering full order lifecycle management, including assignment, routing, cancellation flows and offline error states for low-connectivity environments.
- Built the group's first cross-product design system from scratch covering web and mobile, delivering consistent components across all platform modules within a one-month sprint.

UX Designer | Interbank Sep 2017 - Jan 2020

- Promoted from UX Trainee to UX Designer after eight months, taking on end-to-end ownership of Interbank's main banking app roadmap.
- Served as lead designer for Interbank's main banking app for two years, owning the design roadmap one sprint ahead of development and conducting field research to inform iterative improvements.
- Redesigned the commercial section of the app promoting financial products, with Extracash (a short-term lending product) seeing approximately 40-50% growth in adoption following implementation.
- Led UX design for Plin in collaboration with BBVA and Scotiabank designers, facilitating co-design workshops to align three competing institutions around a shared user-centred vision.
- Designed a differentiated onboarding journey for first-time credit card holders across two distinct user segments (young adults and homemakers), coordinating directly with marketing teams and external agencies.
- Conceptualised and validated Frilea through Labentana's innovation lab, a service matching unbanked freelancers with gigs while building their credit score, combining field research with expert interviews and prototype testing. Frilea launched as a live product before being discontinued during the pandemic.
- Conducted a 2-day field research sprint with agricultural workers in La Libertad to redesign their payroll access experience, reframing the problem from digital usability to physical access constraints and prototyping a cardless withdrawal solution using existing ATM infrastructure.
- Contributed to Billy, an experimental payments app that won Intercorp's Best Beta App award, supporting iterative design improvements across multiple app iterations.

EDUCATION

MA Service Design | UAL London College of Communication Oct 2023 - Dec 2024

- Major project: designed AfterCare+, a two-sided digital platform for NHS Pioneer Centre, producing fully interactive prototypes for a patient mobile app and a nurse tablet dashboard covering health data tracking, personalised care resources, direct messaging and clinical annotation tools, as well as developing a strategic roadmap using anticipatory innovation methods.
- Live projects with CIPD (career pathways service for young people) and DEFRA (sustainable farming framework for Net Zero 2050 using design futures methods).

BA Industrial Design | Pontifical Catholic University of Peru Mar 2011 - Jul 2017

- 4th year project selected for Global Grad Show at Dubai Design Week 2017. 5th year project awarded Critic's Award at PUCP Design Exhibition.

SKILLS AND TOOLS

Design and Prototyping: Figma, FigJam, Miro, Adobe XD, Sketch, Adobe Creative Suite

Research and Testing: Qualitative interviews, service safaris, contextual inquiry, participatory design, usability testing, Maze, UserTesting, Dovetail

Product Design Methods: User flows, wireframing, interaction design, design systems, mobile and responsive design, accessibility, Double Diamond

Agile and Collaboration: Scrum, sprint planning, cross-functional facilitation, stakeholder management, Notion

AI and Emerging Tools: Fluent in using AI tools to move from design to working code. Built and shipped a fully functional bilingual web app (HTML, CSS, JavaScript) with real-time interactive features, RSVP forms, animations and live deployment on GitHub Pages, closing the gap between design vision and product delivery without relying on engineering handoff.

Languages: English (advanced), Spanish (native)

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

- Selected Exhibitor | Global Grad Show, Dubai Design Week 2017
- 1st Place | Innovation Award, Interbank
- Critic's Award | PUCP Design Exhibition